Ruins around the Colosseum

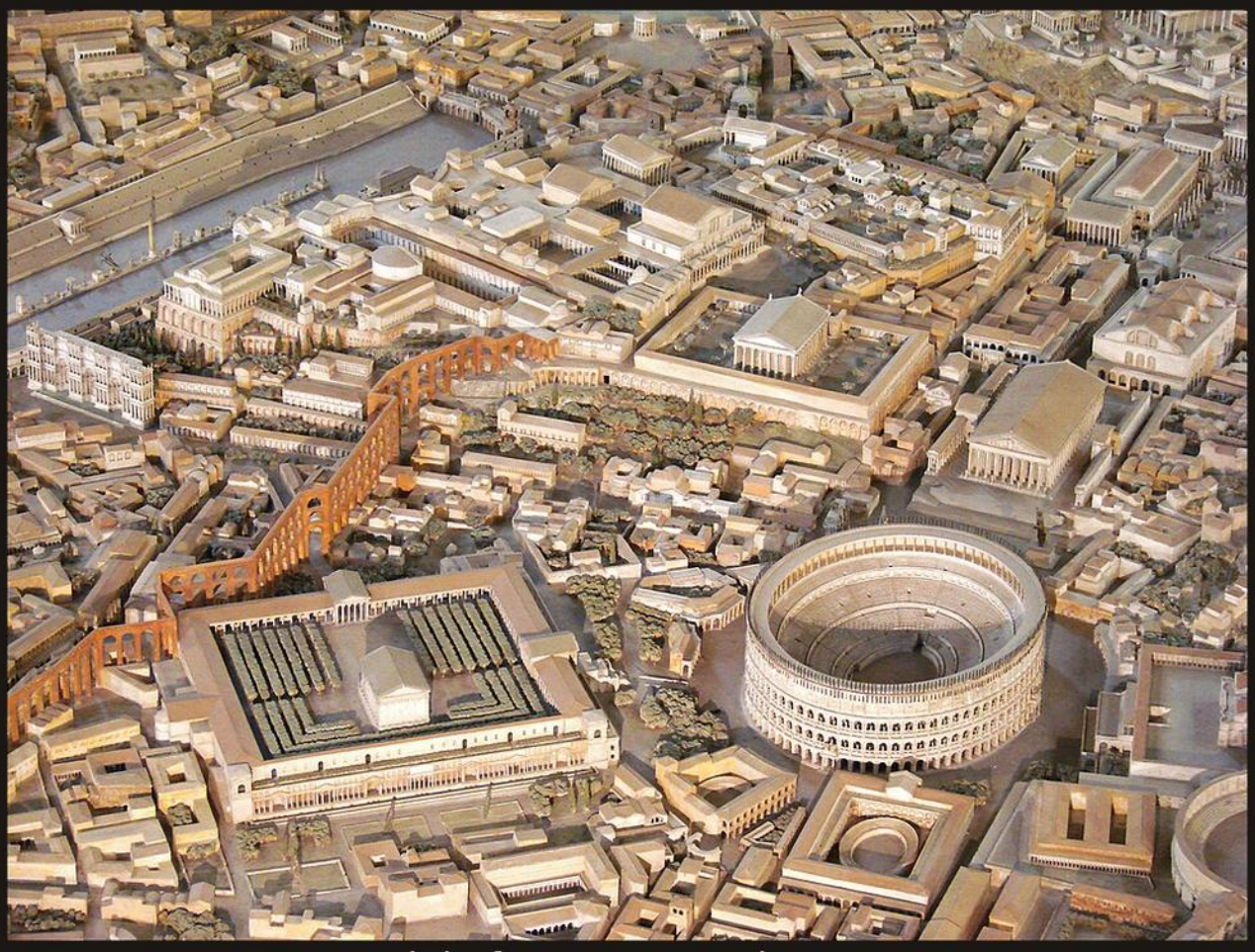
A short picture guide

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1. How it looked

Where: Everything around you, 1700 years ago

- This is a model of ancient Rome.
- The round building is the Colosseum.
- All the ruins you see were once parts of this busy city.



Model of Rome around AD 320

2. The Colosseum

Where: The big one

- Opened in AD 80. About 50,000 people sat here.
- They watched gladiator fights and wild animal hunts. Entry was free.
- Under the floor were tunnels and lifts. Animals came up through trapdoors.



Outside



Inside: you can see the tunnels under the old floor



Photo from 1858

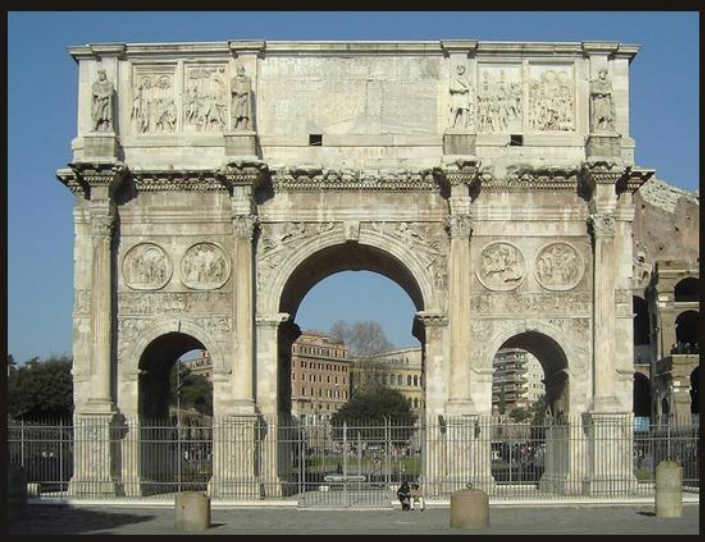
3. Arch of Constantine

Where: Next to the Colosseum, toward the Palatine

- Built in AD 315 for Emperor Constantine.
- It celebrates his win in a civil war.
- Many of the sculptures were taken from older monuments and reused.



South side



North side



Reused relief showing an older emperor

4. Meta Sudans (low round ruin)

Where: Small circle of stones between the Arch and the Colosseum

- This was a big cone-shaped fountain. Water ran down its sides.
- It stood for 1800 years.
- In 1936 it was removed to make a road. Only the base is left.



The cone (bottom right) in 1858



The area today

5. Ludus Magnus – gladiator school

Where: East of the Colosseum, on the street side

- This was the biggest training school for gladiators.
- They lived and practised here in a small arena.
- A tunnel led straight into the Colosseum.



The ruins today



Half of the practice arena, with the Colosseum behind

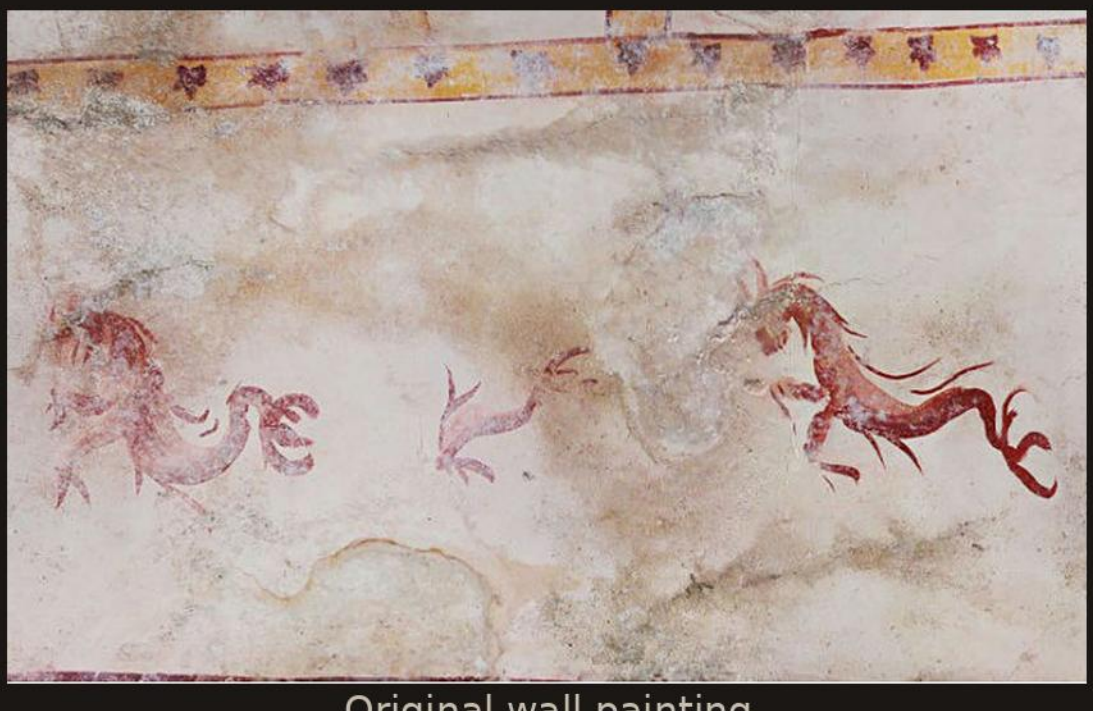
6. Domus Aurea – Nero's Golden House

Where: Under the park on the hill north of the Colosseum (Colle Oppio)

- After the great fire of AD 64, Emperor Nero built a huge palace here.
- It had a big lake where the Colosseum stands now.
- Later emperors filled it in and built over it. Today it is underground. You can visit with a tour.



Octagonal room with a hole in the roof



Original wall painting

7. Temple of Venus and Roma

Where: The raised platform between the Colosseum and the Forum

- The largest temple of ancient Rome. Built by Emperor Hadrian around AD 135.
- Two goddesses, back to back: Venus (love) and Roma (the city).
- The bushes on the platform mark where the columns stood.

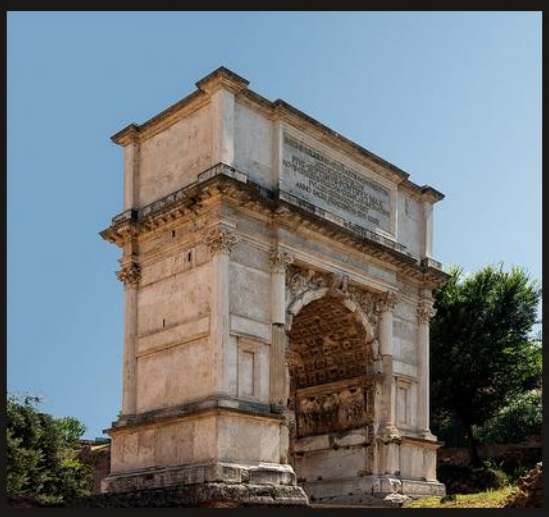


The platform, seen from the Colosseum

8. Arch of Titus

Where: At the top of the road into the Forum

- Built around AD 81 for Emperor Titus.
- It remembers his capture of Jerusalem in AD 70.
- Inside, a carving shows soldiers carrying the Temple's menorah (big candle holder).



The arch



Carving with the menorah



"The Senate and People of Rome to the divine Titus"

9. The Roman Forum

Where: The valley full of ruins west of the Colosseum

- The heart of the city.
- Romans came here to shop, go to court, vote, hear speeches and pray.
- Over the centuries it was buried and forgotten. It was dug up again in the 1800s–1900s.



The Forum today



Seen from Capitoline Hill

10. Basilica of Maxentius

Where: Three giant brick arches on the Forum's north side

- Built AD 308–312. The biggest building in the Forum.
- A "basilica" was not a church. It was a hall for courts and business.
- What you see is only one side. The middle was even taller.



The three huge arches



Close up

11. Temple of Antoninus and Faustina

Where: Columns with a church behind them

- Emperor Antoninus built it in AD 141 for his dead wife Faustina.
- Later a church was built inside it.
- That is why it survived so well.

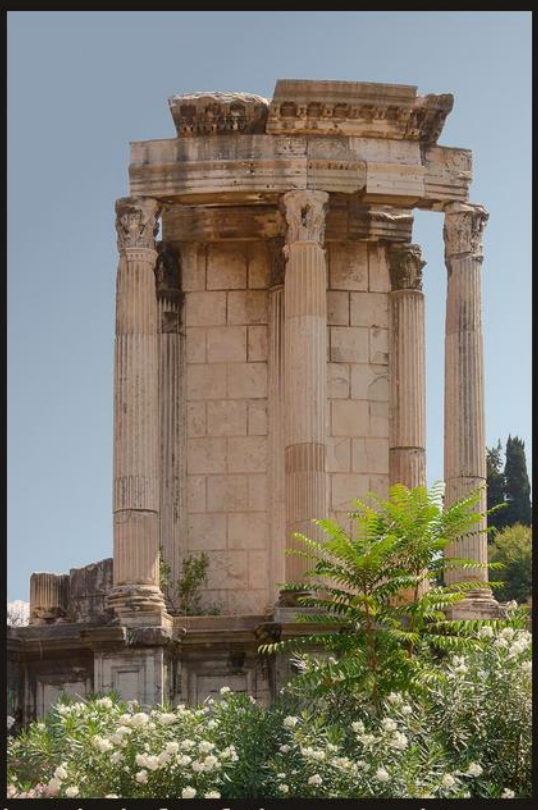


Roman columns, church front

12. Temple of Vesta

Where: Small round temple in the Forum

- Six priestesses, the Vestal Virgins, kept a sacred fire burning here.
- Romans believed if the fire went out, Rome was in danger.
- The women lived next door, in the House of the Vestals.



What is left of the round temple



Vesta area with the columns of Castor and Pollux

13. Temple of Castor and Pollux

Where: Three tall columns standing alone

- For the twin gods Castor and Pollux.
- Romans believed the twins helped them win a battle in 495 BC.
- The temple also checked weights and measures for traders.



The three columns

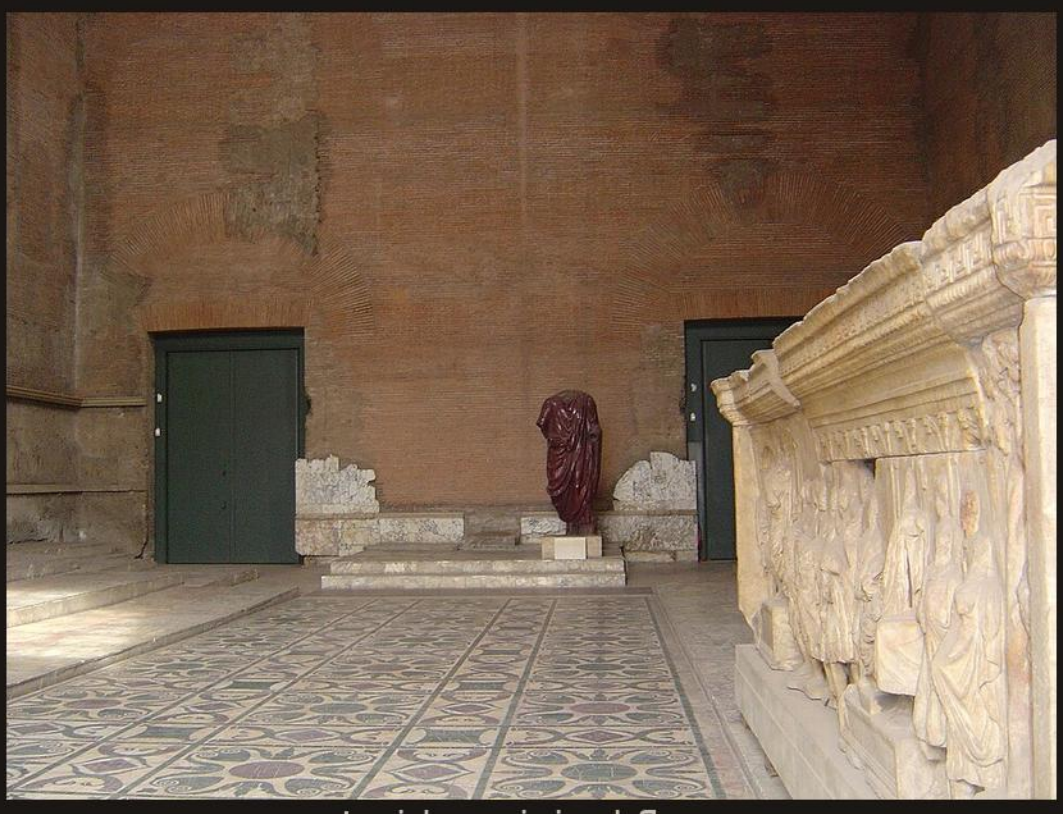
14. Curia – Senate House

Where: Tall plain brick building

- The Roman Senate met here. Started by Julius Caesar.
- It became a church in the 600s. That saved it.
- Inside, the original marble floor is still there.



Outside



Inside, original floor

15. Arch of Septimius Severus

Where: Big arch at the far end of the Forum

- Built in AD 203.
- It celebrates the emperor's wins in wars in the East (today's Iraq).



The arch

16. Temple of Saturn

Where: Eight columns at the far end

- One of the oldest temples in Rome (first built about 497 BC).
- It held the state treasury – Rome's gold and silver.
- Its winter festival, Saturnalia, had parties and gifts.



The columns, with the Forum behind

17. Palatine Hill

Where: The green hill south-west of the Colosseum

- Legend says Rome was founded here by Romulus.
- Rich Romans, then emperors, built their homes here.
- The word "palace" comes from "Palatine".



From the Colosseum



Palace ruins seen from the Circus Maximus

18. Circus Maximus

Where: Long grassy field behind the Palatine

- A huge stadium for chariot races.
- Around 150,000 people could watch.
- Today it is a park. Some ruins remain at the curved end.



The race track is the long flat field



Ruins at the curved end